26. Which one of the following statements constitutes the central theme of this passage ?

(a) Countries with greater economic prosperity are better equipped to deal with the consequences of climate change.

(b) Adaptation and mitigation should be integrated with development strategies.

(c) Rapid economic growth should not be pursued by both developed and developing economies.

(d) Some countries resort to over exploitation of natural resources for the sake of rapid development.

Ans. (b) The central theme of the passage is "Adaptation and mitigation should be integrated with development strategies", as it is clearly stated in passage that adaptation and mitigation need to be integrated into a climate smart development strategy that increases resilience, reduces the threat of global warming and improve development outcomes.

Directions for the following 11 (eleven) items : Read the following three passages and answer the items that follow each passage. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage-1

Invasions of exotic species into new geographic areas sometimes occur naturally and without human agency. However, human actions have increased this trickle to a flood. Human-caused introductions may occur either accidentally as a consequence of human transport, or intentionally but illegally to serve some private purpose or legitimately to procure some hoped-for public benefit by bringing a pest under control. Producing new agricultural products or providing noval recreational opportunities. Many introduced species are assimilated into communities without much obvious effect. However, some have been responsible for dramatic changes to native species and natural communities. For example, the accidental introduction of the brown tree snake ***Bioga irregularies*** into Guam, an island in the Pacific, has through nest predation reduced 10 endemic forest bird species to the point of extinction.

One of the major reasons for the world's great biodiversity is the occurrence of centers of endemism so that similar habitats in different parts of the world are occupied by different groups of species that happen to have evolved there. If every species naturally had access to everywhere on the globe, we might expect a relatively small number of successful species to become dominant in each biome. The extents to which this homogenization can happen naturally is restricted by the limited powers of dispersal of most species in the face of the physical barriers that exist to dispersal. By virtue of the transport opportunities offered by humans, these barriers have been breached by an ever-increasing number of exotic species. The effects of introductions have been to convert a hugely diverse range of local community compositions into something much more homogeneous.

It would be wrong, however, to conclude that introducing species to a region will inevitably cause a decline in species richness there. For example, there are numerous species of plants, invertebrates and vertebrates found in continental Europe but absent from the British Isles (many because they have so far failed to recolonize after the last glaciations). Their introduction would be likely to segment British biodiversity. The significant detrimental effect noted above arises where aggressive species provide a noval challenge to endemic biotas. ill – equipped to deal with them.

27. With reference to the passage, which of the following statements is correct?

(a) Introduction of exotic species into new geographical areas always leads to reduced biodiversity.

(b) Exotic species introduced by man into new areas have always greatly altered the native ecosystems.

(c) Man is only reason to convert a hugely diverse range of local community compositions into more homogeneous ones.

(d) None of the statements (a), (b) and (c) is correct in this context.

Ans. (d) According to the passage, invasion of exotic species into new geographic areas, sometimes occur naturally and without human agency. Thus statement 1 is wrong. Exotic species introduced by man into new areas have always greatly altered the native ecosystem is not correct as per the passage. Thus, statement 2 is wrong. Man is not only reason to convert a hugely diverse range of local community compositions into more homogeneous one. Thus, all the statements are wrong and option (d) is correct.

28. Why does man introduce exotic species into new geographical areas ?

1. To breed exotic species with local varieties.
2. To increase agricultural productivity.
3. For beautification and landscaping.

Which of the above statements is /are correct ?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) According to the passage man introduce exotic species into new geographical areas to breed exotic species with local varieties and to increase agricultural productivity and for beautification and landscaping. All the statements are correct.

29. How is homogenization prevented under natural conditions?

(a) Evolution of groups of species specific to local habitats.

(b) Presence of oceans and mountain ranges.

(c) Strong adaptation of groups of species to local physical and climatic conditions.

(d) All the statements (a),(b) and (c) given above are correct in this context.

Ans. (d) Evolution of groups of species specific to local habitats and presence of oceans and mountain ranges and strong adaptation of groups of species to local physical and climatic conditions are homogenization prevented under natural conditions. Thus, all the statements a, b, c are correct.

30. How have the human beings influenced the biodiversity ?

1. By smuggling live organisms.
2. By building highway.
3. By making ecosystems sensitive so that new species are not allowed.
4. By ensuring that new species do not have major impact.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3

(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4

Ans. (a) The human beings influenced the biodiversity by smuggling live organism and by building highway. Thus, only options (1) and (2) are correct.

31. What can be the impact of invasion of exotic species on an ecosystem ?

1. Erosion of endemic species
2. Change in the species compositions of the community of the ecosystem.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) According to the passage, many introduced species are assimilated into communities without much obvious effect. However, some have been responsible for dramatic changes to native species and natural communities and thus both the statements are correct.

Passage-2

Most champions of democracy have been rather reticent in suggesting that democracy would itself promote and enhancement of social welfare-they have tended to see them as good but distinctly separate and largely independent goals. The detractors of democracy, on the other hand, seemed to have been quite willing to express their diagnosis of what they see as serious tensions between democracy and development. The theorists of the practical split-''Make up your mind do you want democracy, or instead, do you want development ?''-often came, at least to start with, from East Asian countries, and their voice grew in influence as several of these countries were immensely successful-through the 1970s and 1980s and even later- in promoting economic growth without pursuing democracy.

To deal with these issues we have to pay particular attention to both the content of what can be called development and to the interpretation of democracy (in particular to the respective roles of voting and of public reasoning). The assessment of development cannot be divorced from the lives that people can lead and the real freedom that they enjoy Development can scarcely be seen merely in terms of enhancement of inanimate objects of convenience, such as a rise in the GNP (or in personal incomes), or industrialization- important as they may be as means to the real ends. Their value must depend on What they do to the lives and freedom of the people involved, which must be central to the idea of development.

If development is understood in a broader way. With a focus on human lives, then it becomes immediately clear that the relation between development and democracy has to be seen partly interims of their constitutive connection, rather than only through their external links. Even though the question has often been asked whether political freedom is ''conducive to development'' we must not miss the crucial recognition that political liberties and democratic rights are among the ''constituent components'' of development. Their relevance for development does not have to be established indirectly through their contribution to the growth of GNP.

32. According to the passage, why is a serious tension perceived between democracy and development by the detractors of democracy ?

(a) Democracy and development are distinct and separate goals.

(b) Economic growth can be promoted successfully without pursuing a democratic system of governance.

(c) Non-democratic regimes deliver economic faster and far more successfully than democratic ones.

(d) All the statements (a), (b) and (c) given above are correct in this context.

Ans. (b) According to the passage, the serious tension perceived between democracy and development by the detractors of democracy because the economic growth can be promoted successfully without pursuing a democratic system of governance.

33. According to the passage, what should be the ultimate assessment/aim /view of development ?

(a) Rise in the per capita income and industrial growth rates.